# MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

CI/CD & Infrastructure Engineer | QA Automation

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent hands-on work in CI/CD, Kubernetes-based test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines supporting three product teams and has delivered faster pipelines and short-lived merge-request environments. Builds and operates a personal k3s homelab using GitOps, monitoring tools and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure. Studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

## CORE SKILLS

**Infrastructure & CI/CD:** GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD
**Monitoring & data:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
**Languages & tools:** Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)
**Testing:** pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw** *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to CI used in team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023. Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

**QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw** *2019–2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

**Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House** *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

## SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

**Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal** *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

**Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health** *2023–2024*

- Delivered per-merge-request environments with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; enabled QA and product reviews before merge and end-to-end testing against each environment.

## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

**BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology** 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — studying; exam scheduled for January 2027

## ADDITIONAL LEARNING

Terraform Associate practice tests completed; certification exam not taken.
AWS learning: basic EC2 and S3 experience through free-tier learning activities.

## LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)